



Be prepared for those first diaper changes. Bring a package of newborn diapers, some diaper bags, and cotton balls with you.

Clothes for the baby Have a few items of newborn clothes ready, such as sleep suits and undershirts. Include a cardigan or jacket, and hat for leaving the hospital and taking your baby home. Make sure the baby's car seat is ready, too.

Have a camera or phone charged and ready to take those first pictures of your amazing new baby. You could pack a charger to be on the safe side.

Clothes for giving birth Pack your labor outfit! An old, comfortable nightie or top is ideal and a pair of socks for warmth and comfort, or you may want a bikini top if you're planning a water birth.

Take some magazines or music and headphones to keep you occupied between contractions, especially if you take pain relief.

FASCINATING FACTS

It may be hard to believe some of these facts, but you'll soon find out from your own experience as a new parent.

12 diapers

This is the average number that a baby needs per day. She will urinate every 1-3 hours and will poop several times a day.

40 days

In some cultures around the world, this is the time frame that mother and baby are encouraged not to leave the house in order to fully recover from the birth.

3 outfits

Most babies will need three or more outfit changes a day. Make sure you have enough clothes ready for your newborn baby's wardrobe.

16 weeks

You might look about 16 weeks pregnant right after the birth. Your uterus still needs to go back to its prepregnancy size and you'll have weight from pregnancy that takes a while to lose.

5,850

This is the average number of diapers that a child will use in her lifetime.